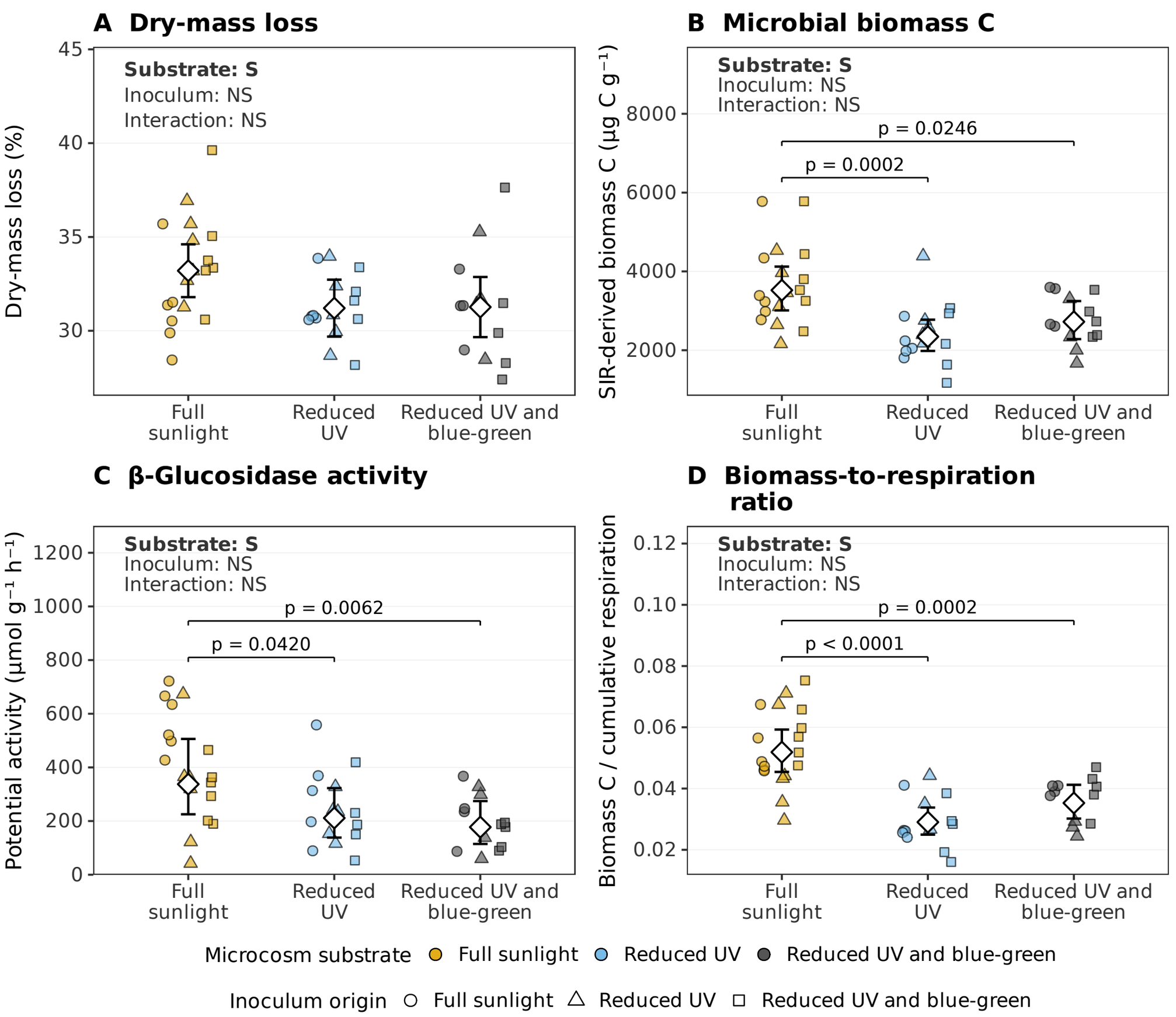
A Dry-mass loss
Substrate: S
Inoculum: NS
Interaction: NS
Dry-mass loss (%)
45
40
35
30
Full sunlight
Reduced UV
Reduced UV and blue-green
B Microbial biomass C
Substrate: S
Inoculum: NS
Interaction: NS
p = 0.0246
p = 0.0002
SIR-derived biomass C (µg C g⁻¹)
8000
6000
4000
2000
C β-Glucosidase activity
Substrate: S
Inoculum: NS
Interaction: NS
p = 0.0062
p = 0.0420
Potential activity (µmol g⁻¹ h⁻¹)
1200
1000
800
600
400
200
0
D Biomass-to-respiration ratio
Substrate: S
Inoculum: NS
Interaction: NS
p = 0.0002
p < 0.0001
Biomass C / cumulative respiration
0.12
0.10
0.08
0.06
0.04
0.02
Microcosm substrate Full sunlight Reduced UV Reduced UV and blue-green
Inoculum origin Full sunlight Reduced UV Reduced UV and blue-green